Persist Week of August 10, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com. We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday, August 10th, 2026
- Tuesday, August 11th, 2026
- Wednesday, August 12th, 2026
- Thursday, August 13th, 2026
- Friday, August 14th, 2026
- Saturday, August 15th, 2026
- Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday, August 10th, 2026
- Tuesday, August 4th, 2026
- Tuesday, August 11th, 2026
- Wednesday, August 12th, 2026
- Thursday, August 13th, 2026
- Friday, August 14th, 2026
- Saturday, August 15th, 2026
- Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday, August 10th, 2026
- Tuesday, August 11th, 2026
- Wednesday, August 12th, 2026
- Thursday, August 13th, 2026
- Friday, August 14th, 2026
- Saturday, August 15th, 2026

- Sunday, August 16th, 2026
- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday, August 10th, 2026
  - Tuesday, August 11th, 2026
  - Wednesday, August 12th, 2026
  - Thursday, August 13th, 2026
  - Friday, August 14th, 2026
  - Saturday, August 15th, 2026
  - Sunday, August 16th, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday, August 10th, 2026
  - Tuesday, August 11th, 2026
  - Wednesday, August 12th, 2026
  - Thursday, August 13th, 2026
  - Friday, August 14th, 2026
  - Saturday, August 15th, 2026
  - Sunday, August 16th, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday, August 10th, 2026
  - Tuesday, August 11th, 2026
  - Wednesday, August 12th, 2026
  - Thursday, August 13th, 2026
  - Friday, August 14th, 2026
  - Saturday, August 15th, 2026
  - Sunday, August 16th, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday, August 10th, 2026
  - Tuesday, August 11th, 2026
  - Wednesday, August 12th, 2026
  - Thursday, August 13th, 2026
  - Friday, August 14th, 2026
  - Saturday, August 15th, 2026
  - Sunday, August 16th, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday, August 10th, 2026
  - Tuesday, August 11th, 2026
  - Wednesday, August 12th, 2026

Thursday, August 13th, 2026
Friday, August 14th, 2026
Saturday, August 15th, 2026
Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, August 10th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Week 5 - Pendlay Row Progression
Back to the Pendlay row with reps dropping from the previous Pendlay row session. Fewer reps means more weight on the bar. Same dead stop on the floor each rep, same parallel torso, same controlled tempo. The drop set at the end should push the back close to full fatigue.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Dual Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
3. Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo (Aim for 8+ reps)

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your pull-ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging pull ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Hammer Curl; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 15-30 sec
2. DB Waiter Curl Pulses; 20 sec
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
2. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday, August 11th, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Narrow Grip DB Bench Progression

Back to the narrow grip DB bench with reps dropping from Week 2. Fewer reps means the weight goes up. The same load per RPE principle applies. Each set the RPE climbs, which means each set the weight climbs. The 30X0 tempo stays the same. Keep moving continuously from one rep to the next with a slow descent and no pausing at the top. Use your Week 2 sets as the baseline and add from there.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup:
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
2. Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Incline Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Narrow Grip Dumbbell Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance:
3 sets
1. Barbell Skullcrusher; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Hands on Bench Tricep Push Up; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. For the push ups you may take small breaks as needed.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Incline DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown:
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 12th, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Hip Thrust Progression
Back to the barbell hip thrust with reps dropping from the previous hip thrust session. Fewer reps means the weight goes up. The same one second pause at the top applies. Add weight from the previous session where you can. The glutes should be working hard by the second set. If they are not, the weight is too light.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
3. Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Barbell Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. KB Rack Cossack Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Seated Calf Raise; 12-15 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Feet Anchored Sit Up; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Tuck L Sit; 30 sec or Single Leg Tuck L Sit; 10-15 sec/side or L Sit; 15-30 sec
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday, August 13th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work - easy effort
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
- 12 V Up
- 12 Hollow Rocks
- 12 Tuck Up
- 20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, 30, and 40, stop and perform:
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
- 10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
- 10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Friday, August 14th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Half Kneeling Landmine Press Progression
Back to the half kneeling landmine press with reps dropping from Week 2. Fewer reps means more weight. The same setup applies. Back knee into the floor, front shin vertical, press along the natural arc of the landmine. Use your Week 2 working weights as a starting point and add from there. The stability demand on the core and hip flexors does not change just because the load is heavier.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
3. Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm DB Row; 10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Seated DB Lateral Raise; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Zottman Curl; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. KB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side

2. Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
3. Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, August 15th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Goblet Squat Progression
Back to the goblet squat with reps dropping from Week 2. Fewer reps means the weight goes up. The same depth standard applies. Use your Week 2 working weight as a starting point and add from there. The max unbroken set at the end uses the Set 1 weight. By that point the legs have already been through three increasingly difficult sets so expect the last set to require full effort. Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
2. Russian KB Swings; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Zercher Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Goblet Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets

1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hand Supported Box Pistol; 5-7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Russian Twist; 10-15 reps/side
rest 45 sec
2. DB Side Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
2. Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Your body doesn't know the difference between the stress of a hard workout and the stress of a difficult week at work. It just knows stress and it responds accordingly.

When life is piling on, your recovery takes a hit even if your training hasn't changed. Sleep gets worse, cortisol stays elevated, your body holds onto tension it can't release. A lot of people push harder in the gym during the most stressful periods of their life and then wonder why they feel worse, not better.

This isn't an argument for backing off every time things get hard. It's an argument for paying attention. On the weeks where life stress is high, training might need to look a little different. Shorter, lower intensity, more restorative. That's not a step backward. That's actually a sophisticated way to train. The people who learn to adjust based on what their body actually needs tend to make more progress over time than the ones who just follow the plan no matter what.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, August 10th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Pendlay Row Progression
Back to the Pendlay row with reps dropping from Week 2. Fewer reps means more weight on the bar. Same dead stop on the floor each rep, same parallel torso, same controlled tempo. Use your max unbroken set from the previous Pendlay row session to guide where your working weight starts this week. The drop set at the end should push the back close to full fatigue.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
2. Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Incline Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo (Aim for 8+ reps)

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Skullcrusher; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Hands on Bench Tricep Push Up; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. For the push ups you may take small breaks as needed.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Incline DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 4th, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Tuesday, August 11th, 2026

Barbell Hip Thrust Progression
Back to the barbell hip thrust with reps dropping from the previous session. Fewer reps means the weight goes up. The same one second pause at the top applies. Use your previous working weights as a starting point and add from there. The glutes should be working hard by the second set. If they

are not, the weight is too light.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
3. Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Barbell Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. KB Rack Cossack Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Seated Calf Raise; 12-15 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Feet Anchored Sit Up; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. Tuck L Sit; 30 sec or Single Leg Tuck L Sit; 10-15 sec/side or L Sit; 15-30 sec
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Wednesday, August 12th, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Thursday, August 13th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Supinated Pull Up Progression
Back to the heavy pull up cluster. Six sets across two RPE targets with reps decreasing as weight increases. The supinated grip keeps the biceps in a strong position on the bar. As reps go down across the sets, make the movement harder by adding weight or reducing assistance. The first three

sets should feel clearly easier than the last three. Aim to add weight from previous odd weeks.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
3. Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (8 min):
Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your pull-ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging pull ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 Working Sets
1. Narrow Grip Dumbbell Bench Press; 10-15 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Lateral Raise; 10-15 reps @30X0
rest 90 sec

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Zottman Curl; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec
2. KB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
2. Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
3. Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, August 14th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Conventional Deadlift Progression
Back to the conventional deadlift with reps dropping from the previous session. Fewer reps means weight goes up. Keep the hips level at the start of each pull and brace hard before the bar leaves the floor. Use your previous working weights as a starting point and add from there. The posterior chain should be working hard by the second working set.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
2. Russian KB Swings; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Zercher Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 9 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hand Supported Box Pistol; 5-7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Russian Twist; 10-15 reps/side
rest 45 sec
2. DB Side Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
2. Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Saturday, August 15th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work - easy effort
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
- 12 V Up
- 12 Hollow Rocks
- 12 Tuck Up
- 20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, 30, and 40, stop and perform:
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
- 10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
- 10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
3. PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
4. Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
5. Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
7. Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Your body doesn't know the difference between the stress of a hard workout and the stress of a difficult week at work. It just knows stress and it responds accordingly.

When life is piling on, your recovery takes a hit even if your training hasn't changed. Sleep gets worse, cortisol stays elevated, your body holds onto tension it can't release. A lot of people push harder in the gym during the most stressful periods of their life and then wonder why they feel worse, not better.

This isn't an argument for backing off every time things get hard. It's an argument for paying attention. On the weeks where life stress is high, training might need to look a little different. Shorter, lower intensity, more restorative. That's not a step backward. That's actually a sophisticated way to train. The people who learn to adjust based on what their body actually needs tend to make more progress over time than the ones who just follow the plan no matter what.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, August 10th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Pendlay Row
Back to the Pendlay row with reps dropping from Week 3. Fewer reps mean more weight on the bar. Same dead stop on the floor each rep, same parallel torso, same controlled tempo. Use your max unbroken set from the previous Pendlay row session to guide where your working weight starts this week. The drop set at the end should push the back close to full fatigue.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
2. Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Incline Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
Every 2:30 x 4 Working Sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 weight/assistance and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo (Aim for 8+ reps)

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. KB Rack Cossack Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Barbell Hip Thrust; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Russian Twist; 10-15 reps/side
- rest 45 sec
2. DB Side Plank; 20-30 sec/side
- rest 45 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
3. Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 11th, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Wednesday, August 12th, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Supinated Pull Up Progression
Back to the heavy pull up cluster with reps dropping from Week 3. As the reps go down across the sets, make the movement harder by adding weight or reducing assistance. The first three sets should feel clearly easier than the last three. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and add from there. The supinated grip keeps the biceps in a strong position through every rep. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
3. Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Intensity 2 (8 min):
Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your pull-ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging pull ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Skullcrusher; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
- rest 30 sec
2. Hands on Bench Tricep Push Up; 10-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure. For the push ups you may take small breaks as needed.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Incline DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 45 sec
2. DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12-15 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 45 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
1. Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday, August 13th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
3. PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
4. Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
5. Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
7. Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Friday, August 14th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Filly Press
Back to the Seated Filly Press with reps dropping from Week 3. Fewer reps mean more load on the pressing arm. The racked arm still keeps the elbow pointed down and the core engaged through the lateral shift. Use your Week 3 working weights as a starting point and add from there.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Finisher based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Dual Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
3. Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @30X0 Tempo
- rest 60 sec
2. Hand Supported Box Pistol; 5-7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
- rest 90 sec

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 sets
1. Hammer Curl; 10 reps @20X0 Tempo
- rest 15-30 sec
2. DB Waiter Curl Pulses; 20 sec
- rest 90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
2. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Saturday, August 15th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work - easy effort
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
- 12 V Up
- 12 Hollow Rocks
- 12 Tuck Up
- 20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, 30, and 40, stop and perform:
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
- 10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
- 10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
1. Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
2. Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
3. Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
5. Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Your body doesn't know the difference between the stress of a hard workout and the stress of a difficult week at work. It just knows stress and it responds accordingly.

When life is piling on, your recovery takes a hit even if your training hasn't changed. Sleep gets worse, cortisol stays elevated, your body holds onto tension it can't release. A lot of people push harder in the gym during the most stressful periods of their life and then wonder why they feel worse, not better.

This isn't an argument for backing off every time things get hard. It's an argument for paying attention. On the weeks where life stress is high, training might need to look a little different. Shorter, lower intensity, more restorative. That's not a step backward. That's actually a sophisticated way to train. The people who learn to adjust based on what their body actually needs tend to make more progress over time than the ones who just follow the plan no matter what.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, August 10th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Lat Pulldown + Supinated Bent Over Row
Two pulling movements back to back within each working set with no rest between them. The lat pulldown or pull up goes first and targets the lat through a vertical pulling path. Moving immediately into the supinated bent over row keeps the back working through a horizontal pull while the lats are already fatigued. Together, they cover both pulling planes in one continuous effort. Aim to increase weight from Week 2 where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Sprint Hinge Core based on your goals.

A) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
3. Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

B) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Balance (10 min):
Every 3:30 x 3 Working Sets
1. Lat Pulldown or Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8-10 reps @20X1 Tempo
directly into
1. Supinated Bent Over Row; 6-8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest until the remainder of the 3:30
Loading Note:
Perform the pulldown or pull up and then go immediately to the bent over row. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7-8 and then keep the weight the same or increase the weight based on the intensity you want to push today. The reps are staying the same for this cycle with the goal of increasing weight.

D) Sprint Hinge Core (15 min):
4 Sets
Row 20sec @ HIGH TEMPO
rest 15sec
Dumbbell Power Clean x 12 reps
rest 15sec
Star Plank x 20sec/side
rest walk 90sec
Effort Note:
The goal for this conditioning is to push the pace on the cardio machine. The intensity should start relatively high and increase each set. The additional movements should be performed at a consistent but hard pace. The rest is intentional to allow for the higher outputs.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
2. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday, August 11th, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Skullcrusher + Narrow Grip DB Bench
The skullcrusher loads the triceps at the bottom of the range where the long head is most stretched. Moving straight into the narrow grip DB bench keeps the triceps under load through a more familiar pressing pattern while they are already fatigued. The narrow grip shifts the demand from the chest onto the triceps, so the muscle group never gets a real break between the two movements. Push close to failure on both each set. Aim to increase weight from Week 2 where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or High Turnover Push based on your goals.

A) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
2. Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

B) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Incline Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Skullcrusher; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Narrow Grip DB Bench Press; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

D) High Turnover Push (12 min):

10 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) @85% effort
15/12 Row Calories (Male/Female) @ high effort
10 Strict Bar or Ring Dip
8/side Tall Plank Knee to Elbow
Effort Note:
The goal for this week is to test what you have built over the last 5 weeks. Aim to push the pace and see how many rounds you can complete in this conditioning piece.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 12th, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
KB Rack Goblet Curtsy Squat + B-Stance Barbell Hip Thrust
Back to the KB rack cossack squat and barbell hip thrust pairing with the load progressed on both movements. The KB rack position on the cossack adds more demand on the core and upper back to stay upright through the wide lateral range. Add weight from the previous session where you can. The hip thrust one second pause at the top stays the same. If the glutes are not working hard by the second set the weight is too light.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Ab + Leg Pump based on your goals.

A) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
3. Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

B) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

C) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. KB Rack Cossack Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Barbell Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

D) Functional Ab + Leg Pump (12-15 min):
For Time:
20-16-12-8-4
Dumbbell Suitcase Russian Step Up (R+L=2)
*5/4 cal Bike between each set (Male/Female)
rest 2mins
20-16-12-8-4
Cross Body Toe Touch (R+L=2)
*5/4 cal Bike between each set
Effort Note:
This workout features a descending rep scheme for abs and legs, broken up by cardio on a machine. Select a bike pace that matches the rest you need before starting your next set of abs or legs.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday, August 13th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work - easy effort

40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
- 12 V Up
- 12 Hollow Rocks
- 12 Tuck Up
- 20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, 30, and 40, stop and perform:
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
- 10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
- 10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Friday, August 14th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Single Arm DB Row + Seated Lateral Raise Progression
Back to the same pairing as Week 2 with the goal of adding weight or reps on both movements. The single arm row should feel more familiar now. The lateral raise tempo is still the key cue. A fast lateral raise shifts the work to the traps. Slow and controlled, keep it in the side delt where it belongs. Push the weight from Week 2 as much as you can on both movements.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Fatigued Shoulders based on your goals.

A) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
3. Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

B) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Filly Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm DB Row; 10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Seated DB Lateral Raise; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

D) Fatigued Shoulders (15 min):
For Quality
400m Run
30 Dumbbell Floor Press @20X0 Tempo
20 Sprawls
300m Run
20 Dumbbell Floor Press @20X0 Tempo
15 Sprawls
200m Run
10 Dumbbell Floor Press @20X0 Tempo
10 Sprawls
*Dumbbell Weight Suggestion 50/35\#
Effort Note:
This conditioning piece is highly fatiguing for the shoulders. If you are between weights, opt for a lighter weight. You can break up the reps as needed, but try to keep rest to a minimum during the shoulder exercises. Use the run to catch your breath and allow your shoulders to recover.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
2. Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
3. Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, August 15th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Nordic Hamstring Curl + Hand Supported Box Pistol
Back to the Nordic hamstring curl but with a harder single leg movement following it this week. The hand supported box pistol asks the working leg to lower all the way down to the box through a full single leg squat pattern. The hand support is there for balance, not to take load off the leg. Lower with control and drive back up through the heel. Aim to add weight or difficulty to the Nordic compared to previous
weeks.<https://docs.google.com/document/d/11Y00qGv8oG7ndMQnYD19bsp2VWDhQ159L5scxbEsRFM/edit>
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Carry Conditioning based on your goals.

A) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
2. Russian KB Swings; 10-15 reps

B) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Zercher Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hand Supported Box Pistol; 5-7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

D) Carry Conditioning (12-15 min):

2-3 Sets For Quality
60sec Bike @ High Effort
20 American KB Swings 70/53\#
60sec KB Front Rack Carry
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Select a weight that is challenging, but you are able to complete it unbroken for at least the first set. Start this workout at a sustainable pace. Increase the pace each round if you are feeling good.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
2. Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 5x

Your body doesn't know the difference between the stress of a hard workout and the stress of a difficult week at work. It just knows stress and it responds accordingly.

When life is piling on, your recovery takes a hit even if your training hasn't changed. Sleep gets worse, cortisol stays elevated, your body holds onto tension it can't release. A lot of people push harder in the gym during the most stressful periods of their life and then wonder why they feel worse, not better.

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Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, August 10th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Pendlay Row + Supinated Pull Up
Two pulling movements alternating every 75 seconds. The Pendlay row starts each rep from a dead stop on the floor. The supinated pull up follows while the back is still warm from the row. Five reps on each, heavy, building across the three sets. Reps drop as the sets progress. That is the cue to add weight on both the row and the pull up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or High Turnover Push based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
2. Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Incline Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
Every 75 sec x 6 rounds (3 sets each)
1. Pendlay Row; 7 reps @30X0 Tempo
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up; 3 reps @21X1 Tempo

Loading Note:
Pull Up and Pendlay Row reps are heavy this week with the goal of pushing the intensity on both movements. Aim for the first set of each to be about RPE 7-8. Then you can increase or keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets based on how much intensity you are wanting to push today. The Pendlay Row has increased in reps from Week 3, and aim to match the same

weight. The Pull Up has decreased in reps from Week 3, aim to increase weight or decrease assistance. This format is 3 sets of each movement.

E) High Turnover Push (12 min):
10 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) @85% effort
15/12 Row Calories (Male/Female) @ high effort
10 Strict Bar or Ring Dip
8/side Tall Plank Knee to Elbow
Effort Note:
The goal for this week is to test what you have built over the last 5 weeks. Aim to push the pace and see how many total rounds you can complete in this conditioning piece.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 11th, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
KB Rack Cossack Squat + Barbell Hip Thrust
Back to the Cossack and hip thrust pairing with the load progressed on both movements. The KB rack position on the Cossack adds more demand on the core and upper back to stay upright through the wide lateral range. Add weight from the previous session on both movements where you can. The hip thrust one second pause at the top stays the same. If the glutes are not working hard by the second set the weight is too light.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Ab + Leg Pump based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
3. Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Cyclist Back Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. KB Rack Cossack Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Barbell Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Functional Ab + Leg Pump (12-15 min):
For Time:
20-16-12-8-4
Dumbbell Suitcase Russian Step Up (R+L=2)
*5/4 cal Bike between each set (Male/Female)
rest 2mins
20-16-12-8-4
Cross Body Toe Touch (R+L=2)
*5/4 cal Bike between each set (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
This workout contains a descending rep scheme for abs and legs broken up with a cardio machine. Select a pace for the bike that matches the rest you need before starting your next set of abs or legs.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Wednesday, August 12th, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Thursday, August 13th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Skullcrusher + Narrow Grip DB Bench Progression
Back to the skullcrusher and narrow grip DB bench pairing with reps dropping from Week 3.. The long head of the tricep is still the target at the bottom of the skullcrusher. Moving immediately into the narrow grip DB bench keeps the triceps under continuous load. Push close to failure on both movements each set.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Fatigued Shoulders based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
3. Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Skullcrusher; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Narrow Grip DB Bench Press; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Fatigued Shoulders (15 min):
For Quality
400m Run
30 Dumbbell Floor Press @20X0 Tempo
20 Sprawls
300m Run
20 Dumbbell Floor Press @20X0 Tempo
15 Sprawls
200m Run
10 Dumbbell Floor Press @20X0 Tempo
10 Sprawls
*Dumbbell Weight Suggestion 50/35\#
Effort Note:
This conditioning piece is highly fatiguing for the shoulders. If you are between weights, opt for a lighter weight. You can break up the reps as needed, but try to keep rest to a minimum during the shoulder exercises. Use the run to catch your breath and allow your shoulders to recover.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
2. Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
3. Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, August 14th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Nordic Hamstring Curl + Hand Supported Box Pistol
Back to the Nordic hamstring curl but with a harder single leg movement following it this week. The hand supported box pistol asks the working leg to lower all the way down to the box through a full single leg squat pattern. The hand support is there for balance, not to take load off the leg. Lower with control and drive back up through the heel.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Carry Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
2. Russian KB Swings; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hand Supported Box Pistol; 5-7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Carry Conditioning (12-15 min):
2-3 Sets For Quality
60sec Bike @ High Effort
20 American KB Swings 70/53\#
60sec KB Front Rack Carry 70/53\#

rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Select a weight that is challenging, but you are able to complete unbroken for at least the first set. Start this workout at a sustainable pace. Increase pace each round if you are feeling good.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
2. Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Saturday, August 15th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work - easy effort
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
- 12 V Up
- 12 Hollow Rocks
- 12 Tuck Up
- 20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, 30, and 40, stop and perform:
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
- 10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
- 10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
3. PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
4. Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
5. Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
7. Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 4x

Your body doesn't know the difference between the stress of a hard workout and the stress of a difficult week at work. It just knows stress and it responds accordingly.

When life is piling on, your recovery takes a hit even if your training hasn't changed. Sleep gets worse, cortisol stays elevated, your body holds onto tension it can't release. A lot of people push harder in the gym during the most stressful periods of their life and then wonder why they feel worse, not better.

This isn't an argument for backing off every time things get hard. It's an argument for paying attention. On the weeks where life stress is high, training might need to look a little different. Shorter, lower intensity, more restorative. That's not a step backward. That's actually a sophisticated way to train. The people who learn to adjust based on what their body actually needs tend to make more progress over time than the ones who just follow the plan no matter what.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, August 10th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Pendlay Row + Supinated Pull Up Progression
Back to the Pendlay row and supinated pull up pairing with reps dropping from Week 2. Fewer reps means more weight on both movements. The Pendlay row still starts each rep from a dead stop on the floor. The supinated pull up follows while the back is still warm. Use your Week 2 working weights as a starting point and add from there. The drop in reps across the sets is the cue to keep adding weight on both.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Ab + Leg Pump based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
2. Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Incline Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
Every 75 sec x 6 rounds (3 sets each)
1. Pendlay Row; 7 reps @30X0 Tempo
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up; 3 reps @21X1 Tempo

Loading Note:
Pull Up and Pendlay Row reps are heavy this week with the goal of pushing the intensity on both movements. Aim for the first set of each to be about RPE 7-8. Then you can increase or keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets based on how much intensity you are wanting to push today. The Pendlay Row has increased in reps from Week 3, aim to match the same weight. The Pull Up has decreased in reps from Week 3, aim to increase weight or decrease assistance. This format is 3 sets of each movement.

E) Functional Ab + Leg Pump (12-15 min):
For Time:
20-16-12-8-4
Dumbbell Suitcase Russian Step Up (R+L=2)
*5/4 cal Bike between each set (Male/Female)
rest 2mins
20-16-12-8-4
Cross Body Toe Touch (R+L=2)
*5/4 cal Bike between each set (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
This workout contains a descending rep scheme for abs and legs broken up with a cardio machine. Select a bike pace that matches the rest you need before starting your next set of abs or legs.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Tuesday, August 11th, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Wednesday, August 12th, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Barbell Hip Thrust + Hammer Curl
Back to the hip thrust and hammer curl pairing with the load progressed on both movements. The hip thrust drives the glutes through their top range. Drive through the heels and hold the squeeze for one second at the top of every rep. The hammer curl that follows keeps the arms working while the lower body recovers. The neutral grip targets the brachialis, which sits under the bicep and adds to overall arm thickness. Add weight from the previous session on both movements where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or High Turnover Push based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets

1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
3. Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Hip Thrust; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hammer Curl; 8-10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) High Turnover Push (12 min):
10 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) @85% effort
15/12 Row Calories (Male/Female) @ high effort
10 Strict Bar or Ring Dip
8/side Tall Plank Knee to Elbow
Effort Note:
The goal for this week is to test what you have built over the last 5 weeks. Aim to push the pace and see how many total rounds you can complete in this conditioning piece.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday, August 13th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
3. PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
4. Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
5. Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
7. Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Friday, August 14th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Filly Press + Lateral Raise Progression
Back to the same pairing as Week 2 with the goal of adding weight or reps on both movements. The Seated Filly Press reps drop this week, which means the load goes up. The racked arm still keeps the elbow pointing down and the core engaged through the lateral shift. The lateral raise tempo is still the key cue. Slow and controlled, keep it in the side delt where it belongs.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance, or Carry Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
3. Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy

Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Filly Press; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Seated DB Lateral Raise; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Carry Conditioning (12-15 min):
2-3 Sets For Quality
60sec Bike @ High Effort
20 American KB Swings 70/53\#
60sec KB Front Rack Carry 70/53\#
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Select a weight that is challenging, but you are able to complete it unbroken for at least the first set. Start this workout at a sustainable pace. Increase the pace each round if you are feeling good.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
2. Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Saturday, August 15th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work - easy effort
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:

- 12 V Up
- 12 Hollow Rocks
- 12 Tuck Up
- 20 sec Hollow Hold

at minutes 10, 20, 30, and 40, stop and perform:
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
- 10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
- 10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
1. Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
2. Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
3. Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
4. Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
5. Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP COND 3x

Your body doesn't know the difference between the stress of a hard workout and the stress of a difficult week at work. It just knows stress and it responds accordingly.

When life is piling on, your recovery takes a hit even if your training hasn't changed. Sleep gets worse, cortisol stays elevated, your body holds onto tension it can't release. A lot of people push harder in the gym during the most stressful periods of their life and then wonder why they feel worse, not better.

This isn't an argument for backing off every time things get hard. It's an argument for paying attention. On the weeks where life stress is high, training might need to look a little different. Shorter, lower intensity, more restorative. That's not a step backward. That's actually a sophisticated way to train. The people who learn to adjust based on what their body actually needs tend to make more progress over time than the ones who just follow the plan no matter what.

Warmly,
Marcus

Perform

Monday, August 10th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Hang Snatch + Low Hang Snatch
The snatch complex this week combines two reps from the hang with one from the low hang. The hang position is above the knee. Use it to reinforce the hips loading back before the pull. The low hang drops the bar just below the knee, which demands more patience at the bottom and a longer pull before the explosion. Keep the bar close on all three reps and treat each set as a technique session building toward the challenging set.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Run, Hinge, Core based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
3. Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Hang Snatch + 1 Low Hang Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
Every 75 sec x 6 rounds (3 sets each)
1. Pendlay Row; 7 reps @30X0 Tempo
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up; 3 reps @21X1 Tempo

Loading Note:
Pull Up and Pendlay Row reps are heavy this week with the goal of pushing the intensity on both movements. Aim for the first set of each to be about RPE 7-8. Then you can increase or keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets based on how much intensity you are wanting to push today. The Pendlay Row has increased in reps from Week 3, aim to match the same weight. The Pull Up has decreased in reps from Week 3, aim to increase weight or decrease assistance. This format is 3 sets of each movement.

F) Run, Hinge, Core (12 min):
12 min As Many Reps As Possible AMRAP @ sustainable pace
200/150m Run
12 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press (53/35\#) (Male/Female)
24 KB Russian Twist
Effort Note:
Prioritize pacing on the run. The goal will be to have about the same pace on all runs.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
2. Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
3. Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday, August 11th, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Barbell Skullcrusher + Narrow Grip DB Bench Progression
Back to the skullcrusher and narrow grip bench pairing with reps dropping from Week 2. The barbell skullcrusher loads the triceps at the bottom of the range where the long head is most stretched. Moving straight into the narrow grip bench keeps the triceps under continuous load. Push close to failure on both movements each set. Aim to add weight from the previous session where you can.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Chest + Core Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
2. Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Cyclical Hot Start (9 min):
Bike
6 sets
Bike 60 sec @easy pace
Bike 30 sec @hard pace
Effort Note:
Aim for a consistent pace in both sections throughout the full 6 sets. It may take 1-2 sets to determine the appropriate pacing. The 60 sec should feel comfortable, and the 30 seconds should feel annoying but doable. The goal is to improve upon your total cals/distance from Week 2.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Incline Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Skullcrusher; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Narrow Grip DB Bench Press; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

F) Chest + Core Conditioning (12-15min):
For Time
20-15-10-15-20
Calorie Row (Female Rx Cals - 16-12-8-12-16)
Ring Push Up
GHD Sit Up or Anchored Sit Up
rest 30 seconds after each round

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday, August 12th, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Power Clean
Two power cleans per set across five working sets. The power clean catches the bar above parallel which demands speed through the pull and an aggressive elbow turnover before the hips fully extend. Each set is a technique and loading session. Sets 1 and 2 are easy, Sets 3 and 4 moderate, Set 5 challenging. Use the earlier sets to dial in the pull and the catch before adding weight.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Power Endurance based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
3. Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15-18 min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift

10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Power Clean
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Cyclist Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. KB Rack Cossack Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Barbell Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

F) Power Endurance (12-15 min):
12-9-6-3
Power Snatch 115/85\# (Male/Female)
Bar Facing Burpees
- no rest directly into -
15-12-9-6-3
DB Hang Power Clean 50/35\# (Male/Female)

DB Box Step Over 50/35\# (20/16") (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
Push the pace on each couplet. The rest between will not feel like a lot, but it will be enough to keep output high on both pieces.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday, August 13th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work - easy effort
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
- 12 V Up
- 12 Hollow Rocks
- 12 Tuck Up
- 20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, 30, and 40, stop and perform:
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
- 10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
- 10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Friday, August 14th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Split Jerk
Two split jerks per set across five working sets. The split jerk uses the dip and drive to accelerate the bar overhead before splitting the feet into a lunge position to receive it. The focus this week is on the receiving position. The front foot flat, back knee slightly bent, bar locked out directly overhead. Sets 1 and 2 are easy, Sets 3 and 4 moderate, Set 5 challenging. Use the lighter sets to get the footwork before adding weight.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Push Pull Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
3. Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Jerk Progression:
5 working sets; rest 90 sec between sets
2 Split Jerk
Set 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm DB Row; 10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Seated DB Lateral Raise; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Push Pull Conditioning (15 min):
15min As Many Reps As Possible AMRAP @ 85% Effort
3 Wide Grip Strict Pull Ups
12 KB Push Jerks 53/35\# (Male/Female)
3 Narrow Grip Strict Pull Ups
300/240m Row
Effort Note:
Aim to accumulate a lot of quality reps by not hitting failure too soon into the AMRAP. Allow your upper body fatigue to dictate how you are breaking up sets. Push the pace on the row as your breathing will likely be less of a problem than your upper body fatigue.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
2. Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
3. Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday, August 15th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl + Hand Supported Box Pistol Progression
Back to the Nordic and single leg squat pairing with difficulty progressed on both movements. The Nordic hamstring curl is one of the most demanding hamstring movements available. Control the descent as slowly as possible and use the hands to push up from the bottom if needed. The hand supported box pistol asks the working leg to lower all the way to the box through a full single leg squat pattern. The hand support is there for balance, not to offload the leg. Aim to increase difficulty from the previous session on both movements.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Couple of Couplets based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
2. Russian KB Swings; 10-15 reps

C) Aerobic KB Skills (9-12 min):
9-12mins Continuous Effort
Bike 30sec Easy
Bike 30sec Hard
6 Dual KB DL
6 Dual KB Clean
Effort Note:
Select a weight and pace that allows you to practice pacing and KB skill without overly fatiguing yourself for the sections of training to come.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Zercher Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Assisted Nordic Hamstring Curl or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 8-10 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Hand Supported Box Pistol; 5-7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

F) Couple of Couplets (12-15 min):
10 Rounds
10 Cal Bike
5 Goblet Squat (70/53\#) (Male/Female)
3 Goblet Reverse Lunge (R+L=1) (70/53\#) (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
Try to find a pace that is challenging but sustainable. This format allows for you to find a great rhythm.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

1. Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
2. Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

Your body doesn't know the difference between the stress of a hard workout and the stress of a difficult week at work. It just knows stress and it responds accordingly.

When life is piling on, your recovery takes a hit even if your training hasn't changed. Sleep gets worse, cortisol stays elevated, your body holds onto tension it can't release. A lot of people push harder in the gym during the most stressful periods of their life and then wonder why they feel worse, not better.

This isn't an argument for backing off every time things get hard. It's an argument for paying attention. On the weeks where life stress is high, training might need to look a little different. Shorter, lower intensity, more restorative. That's not a step backward. That's actually a sophisticated way to train. The people who learn to adjust based on what their body actually needs tend to make more progress over time than the ones who just follow the plan no matter what.

Warmly,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, August 10th, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Pendlay Row + Supinated Pull Up
Back to the DB Pendlay row and supinated pull up pairing with reps dropping from Week 2. Fewer reps means more weight on both movements. The Pendlay row still starts each rep from a dead stop on the floor. The supinated pull up follows while the back is still warm. Use your Week 2 working weights as a starting point and add from there.

Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or High Turnover Push based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
2. Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Incline DB Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
Every 75 sec x 6 rounds (3 sets each)
1. DB Pendlay Row; 7 reps @30X0 Tempo
2. Supinated Strict Pull Up; 3 reps @21X1 Tempo

Loading Note:
Pull Up and Pendlay Row reps are heavy this week with the goal of pushing the intensity on both movements. Aim for the first set of each to be about RPE 7-8. Then you can increase or keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets based on how much intensity you are wanting to push today. The Pendlay Row has increased in reps from Week 3, aim to match the same weight. The Pull Up has decreased in reps from Week 3, aim to increase weight or decrease assistance. This format is 3 sets of each movement.

E) High Turnover Push (12 min):
10 min As Many Reps As Possible (AMRAP) @85% effort
150m Run
12 Push Up
8/side Tall Plank Knee to Elbow
Effort Note:
The goal for this week is to test what you have built over the last 5 weeks. Aim to push the pace and see how many total rounds of this conditioning piece you can complete.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
2. Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3. Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday, August 11th, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
KB Rack Cossack Squat + DB Hip Thrust
Back to the Cossack and hip thrust pairing with the load progressed on both movements. The KB rack position on the Cossack adds more demand on the core and upper back to stay upright through the wide lateral range. Add weight from the previous session on both movements where you can. If the glutes are not working hard by the second set the weight is too light.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Ab + Leg Pump based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
3. Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Cyclist Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion, scale of 10 where 10 is form failure

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. KB Rack Cossack Squat; 6-8 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. DB Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set, then keep the weight the same for the remainder of the sets, or increase the weight each set if looking to increase intensity.

E) Functional Ab + Leg Pump (12-15 min):
For Time:
20-16-12-8-4
Dumbbell Suitcase Russian Step Up (R+L=2)
*2 Shuttle Run between each set
rest 2mins
20-16-12-8-4
Cross Body Toe Touch (R+L=2)
*2 Shuttle Run between each set
Effort Note:
This workout contains a descending rep scheme for abs and legs broken up with shuttle runs. Select a pace for the shuttle runs that matches the rest you need before starting your next set of abs or legs.
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
2. Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Wednesday, August 12th, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min

Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Thursday, August 13th, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
DB Skullcrusher + Narrow Grip DB Bench Progression
Back to the skullcrusher and narrow grip bench pairing with reps dropping from Week 2. The skullcrusher loads the triceps at the bottom of the range where the long head is most stretched. Moving straight into the narrow grip bench keeps the triceps under continuous load. Push close to failure on both movements each set. Aim to add weight from the previous session where you can. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Fatigued Shoulders based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
3. Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated DB Filly Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. DB Skullcrusher; 6 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Narrow Grip DB Bench Press; 10-12 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

E) Fatigued Shoulders (15 min):
For Quality
400m Run
30 Dumbbell Floor Press @20X0 Tempo
20 Sprawls
300m Run
20 Dumbbell Floor Press @20X0 Tempo
15 Sprawls
200m Run
10 Dumbbell Floor Press @20X0 Tempo
10 Sprawls
*Dumbbell Weight Suggestion 50/35\# (Male/Female)
Effort Note:
This conditioning piece is highly fatiguing for the shoulders. If you are between weights, opt for a lighter weight. You break up the reps however needed, but try to keep rest minimal during the shoulder exercises. Use the run to catch your breath and allow your shoulders to recover.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
2. Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
3. Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday, August 14th, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Hamstring Walk Out + Hand Supported Box Pistol
Back to the hamstring walk out and single leg squat pairing with difficulty progressed on the second movement. The hand supported box pistol asks the working leg to lower all the way down to the box through a full single leg squat pattern. The hand support is there for balance, not to take load off the leg. Lower with control and drive back up through the heel. Aim to increase difficulty from the previous session on both movements.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Carry Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side

2. Russian KB Swings; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance DB RDL
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Hamstring Walk Out; 30-45 sec
rest 60 sec
2. Hand Supported Box Pistol; 5-7 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 8-9 on all sets.

E) Carry Conditioning (12-15 min):
2-3 Sets For Quality
20/side Mountain Climbers
10 Burpee
25 DB Swings 70/50\# (Male/Female)
60sec DB Front Rack Carry 70/50\#
rest 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Select a weight that is challenging, but you are able to complete unbroken for at least the first set. Start this workout at a sustainable pace. Increase pace each round if you are feeling good.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
2. Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Saturday, August 15th, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min total work - easy effort
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
- 12 V Up
- 12 Hollow Rocks
- 12 Tuck Up
- 20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, 30, and 40, stop and perform:
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
- 10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
- 10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
- 10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Shoulder Flexion
1. Passive Hang x 1 min
2. Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
3. PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
4. Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
5. Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
6. Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
7. Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Sunday, August 16th, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

Your body doesn't know the difference between the stress of a hard workout and the stress of a difficult week at work. It just knows stress and it responds accordingly.

When life is piling on, your recovery takes a hit even if your training hasn't changed. Sleep gets worse, cortisol stays elevated, your body holds onto tension it can't release. A lot of people push harder in the gym during the most stressful periods of their life and then wonder why they feel worse, not better.

This isn't an argument for backing off every time things get hard. It's an argument for paying attention. On the weeks where life stress is high, training might need to look a little different.

Shorter, lower intensity, more restorative. That's not a step backward. That's actually a sophisticated way to train. The people who learn to adjust based on what their body actually needs tend to make more progress over time than the ones who just follow the plan no matter what.

Warmly,
Marcus